Prohori — How We Make Money

Business model for the International AI Builders Congress 2026 · Idea to Unicorn → CivicSphere AI → Transparent Government

Prohori ("watchman") is an AI that reads every Bangladesh government contract on the public e-GP website and shows which ones look risky — and **why** — in simple Bangla. **The public uses it free. Businesses pay for deeper features.**

1. The idea in 30 seconds

- The government buys roads, buildings, medicine and more through about **123,000 tenders a year**, worth about **Tk 1 lakh crore a year**.
- Every tender and contract is posted on the government's e-GP website by law. Our app pulls this data automatically every day — **the raw material is free**.
- Our AI turns about **900,000 raw contracts** into useful answers: risk warnings, hidden company networks, fair price ranges, and tender matches.
- Our value is not the data (anyone can see e-GP). Our value is the **analysis** — like Google: websites are public, but Google makes them useful.

2. Why the timing is right

Fact	What it means for us
New rules (PPR 2025) made e-GP mandatory for all government buying from Sept 2025	All public procurement is now online — our data covers the whole market
Average bidders per tender jumped from 2.2 to 8.4	Competition roughly 4x harder — contractors need help to win
143,374 companies registered on e-GP (Nov 2025), the biggest yearly jump ever	A large, growing group of potential paying customers
TIB found the top 5% of contractors won 61% of contract value	Strong public interest in transparency — free users, media attention, trust

3. The core model: free for the public, paid for business

	Free (public watchdog)	Paid (business features)
Who	Citizens, journalists, students, NGOs	Contractors, banks, government offices, donor projects
What they get	Risk patterns by area and office, Bangla Q&A ("Who builds roads in my upazila?"), officially banned companies	Tender alerts, competitor and price intelligence, contractor risk reports, auditor dashboard, API
Why it matters	Builds **trust, fame and media coverage** — this is our marketing	This is our **income**

4. Who pays us — and why

A company pays only when we **make them money, save them money, or protect them from losing money**.

Customer	Their problem	What Prohori gives them	Price idea
1. Contractors (143,000+)	8 bidders per tender now. Hours wasted searching. Guessing the bid price.	**Prohori Pro:** tenders that fit them, past winning-price ranges, who usually wins where	Tk 1,500 / month
2. Banks	They give contractors loans and guarantees. A bad contractor = crores lost.	Contractor risk report: past bans, linked companies, unfinished work	Tk 5–15 lakh / bank / year, or per report
3. Government & auditors (BPPA, CAG, ACC)	Can only check a tiny share of ~123,000 tenders a year.	Ranked list: "check these 200 risky contracts first"	Yearly licence
4. Donor projects (World Bank, ADB, JICA)	Must monitor how their loans are spent; pay consultants to do it by hand.	Automatic integrity monitoring of their projects' contracts	Project contracts (often USD 50k+)
5. Grants	Anti-corruption and open-data funders want tools like this.	A working, proven product	One-time grants

> **Simple version for judges:** Contractors pay because Prohori helps them **win more contracts**. Banks pay because it helps them **avoid bad loans**. Government and donors pay because it helps them **find wasted money faster**. The public uses it free, which builds trust.

5. Example income (illustrative)

These are **assumptions to show the shape of the business**, not tested sales. No customer has been asked yet.

Income source	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Contractors (Tk 1,500/month)	300 users ≈ Tk 54 lakh	1,500 users ≈ Tk 2.7 crore	3,000 users (~2% of market) ≈ Tk 5.4 crore
Banks	3 banks ≈ Tk 24 lakh	8 banks ≈ Tk 64 lakh	15 banks ≈ Tk 1.2 crore
Government / donor projects	1 grant or pilot ≈ Tk 30 lakh	1 contract ≈ Tk 60 lakh	2–3 contracts ≈ Tk 1.5 crore
Other countries (Nepal, Bhutan…)	—	—	1 pilot ≈ Tk 1 crore
Total (approx.)	**≈ Tk 1.1 crore**	**≈ Tk 4 crore**	**≈ Tk 9 crore**

6. Our costs are low

- **Data:** free (published by the government).
- **Cloud + AI:** runs on AWS. The hackathon build costs about **USD 50–75**, covered by our AWS credits.
- **Running cost later:** a few hundred USD a month for servers and AI, growing slowly with users.
- **Team:** the system is mostly automatic, so a small team can run it. The biggest future cost is salaries for sales and support.

Comparison: a UK company doing procurement intelligence (Tussell) charges about **£11,400 per licence per year** and was valued at **£5 million** after early funding in 2018. Similar companies exist in the US (GovSpend). The model works elsewhere; we found no one doing it for Bangladesh.

Sources: BPPA e-GP statistics (Nov 2025); BSS on bidders per tender (2.2 → 8.4); Transparency International Bangladesh e-procurement report (2025); UK G-Cloud listing and UKTech News on Tussell; World Bank ProACT; Open Contracting Partnership (Cardinal); OECD OPSI on Brazil's ALICE; TI Ukraine on DOZORRO. Income figures in section 5 are illustrative assumptions.

7. How we grow

Stage	Goal	Money
Now — hackathon	Free public watchdog + risk model with proof (it flags banned companies **before** the ban)	AWS credits
First 6 months	Launch Prohori Pro for contractors	First subscription income
Year 1	Contractor risk reports for banks	Bigger, steadier income
Year 2+	Licences for government and donor projects	Large contracts
Year 3+	Same product in Nepal, Bhutan and other e-GP countries	Growth beyond Bangladesh

8. Does anything like this already exist?

What exists	Why Prohori is different
e-GP website itself	Shows contracts one by one; no checking or warnings
Dorpatra.com, data scrapers	Copy raw tender data; no analysis
TIB reports	One-time PDF studies; Prohori is a live, searchable tool
World Bank ProACT, Open Contracting "Cardinal"	Global tools; Bangladesh not confirmed; no Bangla, no owner networks
Brazil's ALICE, Ukraine's DOZORRO	Proven AI watchdogs — but only for their own countries

Our moat (why others can't easily copy): a cleaned 15-year contract history, the company–owner network, trained models with measured accuracy, and brand trust.

9. Risks — and our answers

Risk	Our answer
Government limits access to e-GP data	Read gently; later ask BPPA for an official data feed — partner, don't fight
Small contractors pay little	Cheap plans for them; bigger money from banks, government and donors
Government sales are slow	Start with contractors and banks, who decide faster
Political or legal pressure	Never say "corrupt" — only "risk pattern, needs review". A human always decides. Publicly name only companies the government already banned
Others copy the idea	Our 15-year cleaned data, owner network and trained models take time to rebuild

> *"Prohori is free for citizens and paid for business. Contractors pay to win more, banks pay to lose less, and government pays to find waste faster — all built on data the government already publishes for free."*